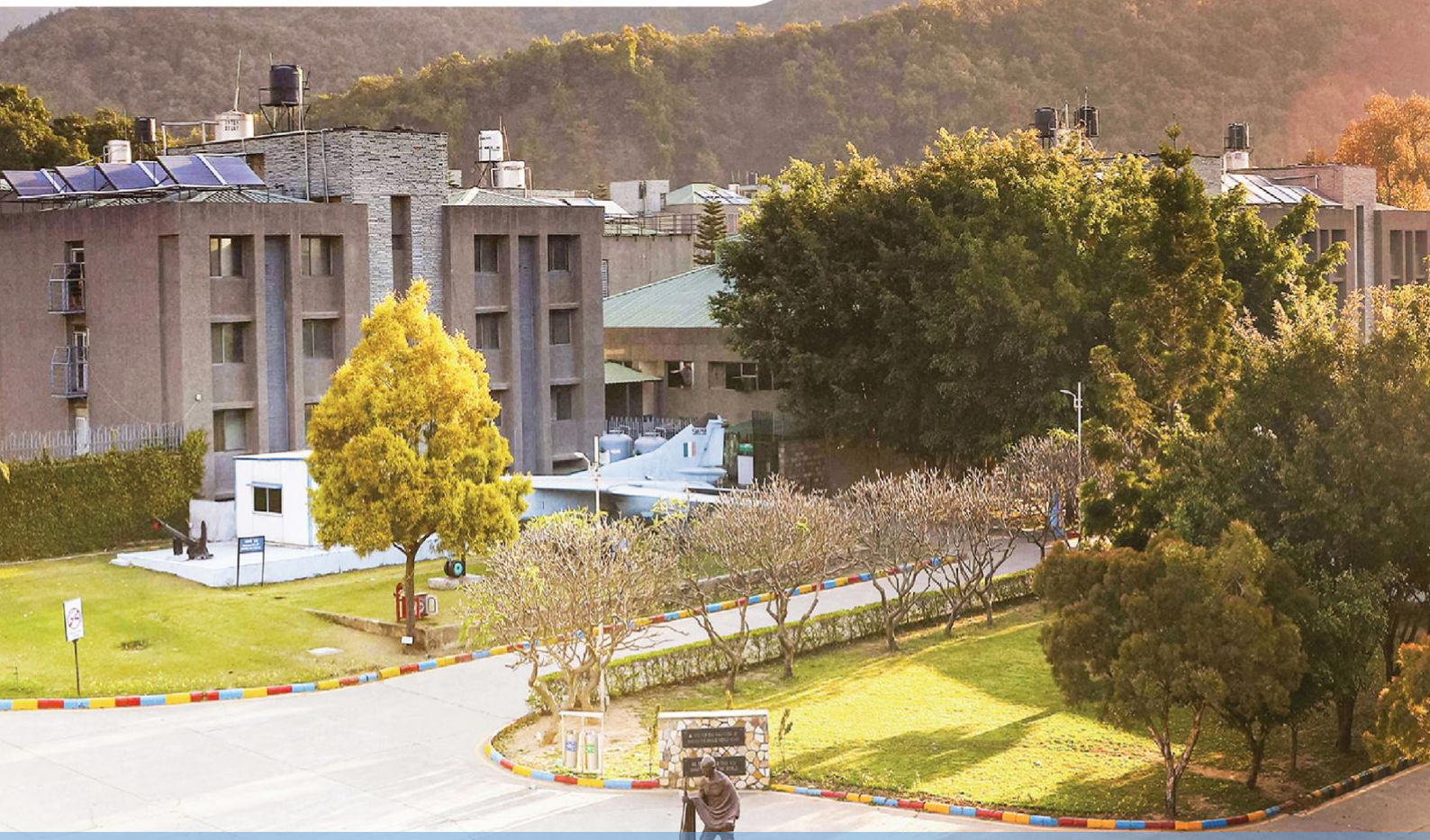
UPES Policy & Governance Manual

A unified framework for University-level governance and policies.



ADDENDUM A:
Faculty & Staff–Specific Policies

Purpose of Addendum

This Addendum forms a part of the UPES Policy & Governance Manual.

It contains policies that are exclusively applicable to faculty and University staff and are therefore not included in the main body of the Manual.

In case of any conflict between this Addendum and the main Policy & Governance Manual, the provisions shall be interpreted in alignment with the overall policy framework of the University.

This Addendum applies to:

- All faculty members (full-time, visiting, adjunct)
- Academic administrators
- Any staff engaged in academic delivery, evaluation, or academic governance processes

These policies are not to be shared with students.

Contains:

Policy Title	**Code**
Policy on Break of Study	AG-18
Advanced Learners Policy	AG-19
Prerequisite Enforcement Policy	AG-20
Question Paper & Result Moderation Policy	AG-21
Composite Teaching Quality Feedback	AG-22

POLICY ON BREAK OF STUDY

(Semester Break / Semester Withdrawal)

(For Internal Use Only – Not for Student Circulation)

(Policy Code: AG – 18)

This Policy shall come into force ***with immediate effect****.*

1. Purpose

1.1 This Policy provides a structured and regulated framework that enables students of UPES to temporarily discontinue their studies**, referred to as a *Break of Study*, *Semester Break*, or *Semester Withdrawal*,** without terminating programme enrollment.

1.2 The Policy seeks to:

1.2.1 Support students facing genuine and documented circumstances requiring temporary discontinuation of studies.

1.2.2 Safeguard academic integrity, credit continuity, and progression standards.

1.2.3 Ensure compliance with UGC regulations on maximum programme duration.

1.2.4 Align with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, including Multiple Entry–Exit provisions.

1.2.5 Establish clarity on academic, financial, residential, and re-entry implications.

2. Applicability and Scope

This Policy applies to:

2.1 All full-time undergraduate and postgraduate students enrolled at UPES across all Schools.

2.2 Approved breaks of **one or more full academic semesters**.

2.3 This Policy does **not** apply to:

2.4 Short-term leave or absence during a running semester (governed by the Attendance Policy).

2.5 Students under disciplinary proceedings, unless specifically approved by the competent authority.

2.6 International students, who shall additionally comply with applicable visa, FRRO, and immigration regulations.

3. Definitions

Term	Definition
Break of Study / Semester Break	An approved temporary suspension of academic enrolment for one full semester, during which the student remains enrolled with the University in an inactive academic status.
Semester Withdrawal	An approved withdrawal granted after the commencement of the semester and within the withdrawal period notified by the

(Mid-Semester)	University, which shall not extend beyond the start of mid-course evaluations.
Re-Entry	The formal process through which a student resumes academic studies after an approved break, subject to academic review and regulatory compliance.
Maximum Programme Duration	The maximum period permitted for completion of a programme as prescribed by the UGC, calculated as the normal programme duration plus two additional academic years (N+2+1).
NEP Multiple Entry–Exit	A framework permitting eligible students to exit with an appropriate academic award and re-enter within the prescribed validity period, in accordance with NEP 2020 and institutional regulations.

4. Guiding Principles

4.1 Student-Centric Consideration: Requests arising from genuine circumstances shall be evaluated with empathy and fairness.

4.2 Academic Integrity: All progression, prerequisite, and curriculum requirements shall continue to apply.

4.3 Due Process: Decisions shall be supported by documentation and recorded in institutional systems.

4.4 Transparency: Academic, financial, and residential implications shall be clearly communicated to students.

4.5 Regulatory Compliance: All break periods shall be counted toward maximum programme duration.

5. Permissible Grounds

5.1 A student may apply for a Break of Study or Semester Withdrawal on one or more of the following grounds:

5.1.1 Medical Grounds – Serious illness, surgery, hospitalization, or prolonged treatment supported by valid medical documentation.

5.1.2 Psychological / Mental Health Grounds – Conditions affecting academic functioning, supported by professional documentation.

5.1.3 Family or Personal Emergencies – Serious illness or death of an immediate family member, relocation, or comparable circumstances.

5.1.4 Financial Hardship – Sudden and demonstrable loss of financial support impacting continuation of studies.

5.1.5 Academic or Professional Opportunities – Approved internships, research, entrepreneurial or equivalent engagements endorsed by the School.

5.1.6 Maternity / Paternity – As per applicable UGC and Government of India guidelines.

5.7 Exceptional Circumstances – Any other circumstance deemed exceptional and approved by the University.

5.2 Requests based solely on avoidance of poor academic performance, dissatisfaction with academic delivery, or intent to repeat a semester without valid cause shall not be entertained.

6. Duration and Limits

6.1 Breaks shall be granted **only in units of one full academic semester**.

6.2 A mid-semester withdrawal shall be treated as one semester for duration calculation.

6.3 A student may ordinarily avail up to **two semesters of break** within the normal programme duration.

6.4 All break periods shall count toward the maximum programme duration (N+2+1).

7. Academic Implications

7.1 No SGPA shall be generated during a planned semester break.

7.2 CGPA shall remain unchanged during the break period.

7.3 Grades for mid-semester withdrawal shall be recorded as per Examination and Assessment Policy timelines.

7.4 All backlogs earned prior to the break shall remain and must be cleared as per applicable regulations on re-entry

7.5 On re-entry, students shall be governed by the **prevailing curriculum**, subject to approved credit equivalence.

7.6 Prerequisite fulfillment and progression norms shall apply upon return.

8. Financial and Residential Implications

8.1 Fee liability shall be governed by the University's Fee Refund and Adjustment Policy, based on the timing of approval.

8.2 Scholarships, financial aid, and assistantships shall ordinarily remain suspended during the break unless expressly approved otherwise.

8.3 Hostel allotment shall stand cancelled during the break period. Re-allotment upon return shall be subject to availability and prevailing rules.

9. Application and Approval

9.1 Applications for Break of Study or Semester Withdrawal shall be made to the Registrar.

9.2 Each application shall undergo academic impact assessment at the School level.

9.3 Final approval authority shall rest with the Registrar, subject to regulatory compliance.

9.4 The University reserves the right to approve, reject, or impose conditions on any request at its discretion.

10. Re-Entry After Break

10.1 Students must apply for re-entry within the approved break period and prior to the commencement of the intended semester.

10.2 Re-entry shall be subject to academic review, curriculum applicability, prerequisite compliance, and maximum duration norms.

10.3 Students returning after extended breaks may be required to undergo academic counselling.

11. NEP 2020 Multiple Entry–Exit

Eligible students may opt for a formal exit with an appropriate academic award instead of availing a prolonged break, in accordance with the NEP Multiple Entry–Exit Policy of the University.

12. Discontinuation

A student shall be treated as **discontinued** if they:

12.1 Fail to apply for re-entry within the approved break period;

12.2 Exceed the maximum permissible programme duration; or

12.3 Voluntarily withdraw from the programme.

Any subsequent re-admission shall be governed by prevailing admission regulations.

13. Appeals

A student may appeal against denial of a Break of Study or re-entry decision within **15 working days** to the Pro- Vice Chancellor.

14. Records and Audit

All applications, approvals, decisions, and supporting documentation shall be maintained in the University ERP system and shall be subject to internal and external audit.

ADVANCED LEARNERS POLICY

(Policy Code – AG 19)

This Policy shall come into force ***with immediate effect.***

1. Purpose

1.1 This Policy enables eligible students to:

1.1.1 Deepen or diversify their degree through Design-Your-Own-Degree (DYOD) pathways such as Minor, Double Minor, or Double Major.

1.1.2 Accelerate or fast-track completion of academic requirements within prescribed regulatory duration norms.

1.1.3 Pursue additional academic enrichment through Audit Courses.

1.1.4 Undertake Independent Study (IS) in approved academic areas.

1.2 This Policy ensures academic rigor, regulatory compliance, workload feasibility, and documented academic governance.

2. Scope & Applicability

2.1 This Policy applies to:

2.1.1 All full-time undergraduate students.

2.1.2 All Schools and Academic Administration Units.

2.1.3 All academic committees responsible for approval and monitoring.

2.2 Programmes governed by statutory or professional councils (including but not limited to PCI-regulated programmes, Law programmes governed by BCI, or any other statutory authority) may be subject to additional or modified progression, credit, or academic structure requirements.

2.3 Fast-track or accelerated progression provisions shall not apply where prohibited by statutory council curriculum, contact-hour, training, or duration requirements.

2.4 In the event of any inconsistency between this Policy and the regulations of the relevant statutory or professional council, statutory provisions shall prevail to the extent of such inconsistency.

2.5 Advanced Learner status shall not exempt a student from compliance with existing academic regulations.

3. Definition and Eligibility

3.1 A student may be designated as an Advanced Learner (AL) if:

3.1.1 CGPA ≥ 8.0 or ranking within the top 15% of the cohort.

3.1.2 No active backlog, F grade, debarment (Ab), or disciplinary hold exists.

3.1.3 All first-year foundational courses defined by the approved programme structure have been completed within prescribed timelines.

3.2 Schools may prescribe higher eligibility thresholds for professionally regulated programmes with approval of the Pro-Vice Chancellor/Vice Chancellor.

3.3 Advanced Learner status shall be reviewed at the end of every semester.

4. Guiding Academic Principles

4.1 Compliance with UGC-prescribed minimum (normative) programme duration and maximum permissible duration (N+2+1).

4.2 Compliance with approved semester credit limits.

4.3 Strict prerequisite enforcement across all pathways.

4.4 No dilution of academic rigor or learning outcomes.

4.5 Approvals shall follow documented governance processes.

4.6 Student wellbeing and workload feasibility shall guide all approvals.

4.7 Advanced Learner status provides structured academic flexibility, not exemption from regulations.

4.8 Additional credits undertaken beyond standard programme structure may attract additional tuition or academic fees as notified by the University.

5. Minor

5.1 A Minor shall consist of a minimum of twenty-four (24) credits earned outside the student's declared Major discipline.

5.2 Completion of a Minor shall require:

5.2.1 Fulfilment of prerequisite and sequencing requirements.
5.2.2 Compliance with maximum programme duration norms (N+2+1).
5.2.3 Academic feasibility within approved semester credit limits.

5.3 Approvals Required:

5.3.1 Approval of Minor Offering School.
5.3.2 Endorsement by Programme Leader.
5.3.3 Recording by APO/Student Records & Examinations.

6. Double Minor

6.1 A Double Minor shall consist of two approved Minors, each comprising at least twenty-four (24) credits.

6.2 Completion may include:

6.2.1 Mapping of approved exploratory credits.
6.2.2 Utilisation of Summer Terms (maximum two courses per Summer Semester).
6.2.3 Semester credit optimisation within approved limits.
6.2.4 Confirmed timetable compatibility.

6.3 Conditions:

6.3.1 Prerequisites must be satisfied independently for each Minor.
6.3.2 Completion must remain within N+2+1 duration limits.
6.3.3 Additional instructional fees shall apply as notified.

6.4 Approvals Required:

6.4.1 Approval from both Minor-offering School's Deans.
6.4.2 Endorsement by Programme Leader.
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7. Double Major

7.1 A Double Major requires completion of all core and elective requirements of two approved Major programmes.

7.2 Eligibility:

7.2.1 Active Advanced Learner status with CGPA ≥ 8.0.
7.2.2 No repeat or failure in Major-1 core courses.
7.2.3 Academic workload capacity certified by the School.

7.3 Academic Provisions:

7.3.1 Overlapping courses may count only where formally approved by the Board of Studies.
7.3.2 Total programme credits may exceed standard curriculum.
7.3.3 Additional tuition fees shall apply for excess credits.
7.3.4 Completion may extend academic duration but must remain within N+2+1 limits.
7.3.5 Double Major approval does not guarantee on-time graduation.

7.4 Approvals Required:

7.4.1 Submission of Individual Study Plan.
7.4.2 Approval by both Deans.
7.4.3 Verification by APO/Student Records.

8. Fast-Track Graduation Mechanisms

8.1 Semester Credit Optimisation (Regular Semester)

8.1.1 Maximum of twenty-seven (27) credits per regular semester under standard approval norms.

8.1.2 Registration beyond 27 credits requires prior approval of the Vice Chancellor.

8.1.3 Under no circumstances shall a student register for more than thirty (30) credits in any **regular semester**.

8.1.4 The 30-credit cap applies only to regular semesters; Summer Term enrolment shall be governed separately under the Summer Term Policy.

8.1.5 All overload registrations must include academic counselling certification, timetable feasibility confirmation, and formal ERP approval.

8.1.6 For statutory council-regulated programmes, semester credit limits shall follow applicable regulatory frameworks.

8.2 Summer Semester Utilisation

8.2.1 Maximum of two (2) courses per Summer Semester.

8.2.2 Subject to course availability, prerequisite clearance, and academic feasibility certification.

8.2.3 Applicable Summer fees shall apply.

8.2.4 Summer enrolment shall not be used to bypass prerequisite sequencing or academic regulations.

8.3 Independent Study (IS)

8.3.1 IS enables structured academic engagement under faculty supervision.

8.3.2 Total IS/Directed Reading/Special Topic credits shall not exceed 15% of prescribed programme credits.

8.3.3 IS shall not bypass prerequisite requirements.

8.3.4 Each IS must include documented syllabus, CLOs, assessment plan, timelines, and deliverables.

8.3.5 Schools shall notify eligible IS areas in advance.

8.3.6 Applicable academic fees shall apply.

8.4 External Credits / MOOCs

8.4.1 External credits shall not exceed 25% of prescribed programme credits.

8.4.2 Mandatory pre-approval by Board of Studies and Academic Council.

8.4.3 Academic equivalence validation by offering School is required.

8.4.4 External credits shall not substitute prescribed core courses.

8.4.5 Approved credits shall be formally recorded in ERP.

9. Audit Courses

9.1 Advanced Learners may enrol in Audit Courses for enrichment.

9.2 Maximum of two (2) Audit Courses during the programme.

9.3 Recorded as AP (Audit Pass) or AF (Audit Fail).

9.4 Audit Courses carry no credits and do not affect CGPA/SGPA.

9.5 Audit Courses shall not substitute credit-bearing requirements.

10. Governance Framework

10.1 An Advanced Learner Approval Committee (ALAC) shall oversee approvals and compliance.

10.2 Composition: Dean, Programme Leader/Cluster Head, APO/Student Records Representative.

10.3 Applications shall be submitted through the Registrar's Office within notified timelines.

10.4 ALAC shall meet once per semester upon receipt of consolidated applications.

10.5 ALAC Responsibilities:

- 10.5.1 Approve Advanced Learner designation.
- 10.5.2 Review Individual Study Plans.
- 10.5.3 Ensure compliance with credit caps, prerequisites, and duration norms.
- 10.5.4 Monitor semester-wise performance.
- 10.5.5 Maintain documented approval records.

11. Review and Revocation of Advanced Learner Status

11.1 Status shall be reviewed each semester.

11.2 Status may be revoked if CGPA falls below 7.5, backlogs accumulate, disciplinary action occurs, or Study Plan provisions are violated.

11.3 Upon revocation:

- 11.3.1 Existing pathways may continue only if endorsed by the School.
- 11.3.2 No new pathway approvals shall be granted.
- 11.3.3 All decisions shall be formally documented.

12. Documentation, Records and Appeals

12.1 All pathways require formal applications, Individual Study Plans, and approvals.

12.2 APO/Student Records shall maintain audit-compliant records.

12.3 Students may appeal rejection or revocation within ten (10) working days.

12.4 First appeal lies with the Dean.

12.5 Final decision rests with the PVC/Vice Provost and shall be binding.

PREREQUISITE MAPPING & ENFORCEMENT POLICY

(Policy Code – AG 20)

This Policy shall come into force ***with immediate effect.***

1. Purpose

1.1 This Policy establishes a university-wide framework for defining, publishing, and enforcing course prerequisites, ensuring:

1.1.1 Logical academic progression.
1.1.2 Curriculum integrity and learning outcome achievement.
1.1.3 Prevention of premature or inappropriate course registration.
1.1.4 Fair and transparent enforcement across all Schools.

1.2 The Policy eliminates unstructured or ad-hoc prerequisite overrides and ensures that recovery pathways, not waivers, are the mechanism for addressing prerequisite gaps.

2. Scope

2.1 This Policy applies to:

2.1.1 All undergraduate and postgraduate programmes at UPES.
2.1.2 All credit-bearing courses across levels.

2.2 This Policy applies across all modes of course delivery, including:

2.2.1 Regular Semester.
2.2.2 Summer Semester.
2.2.3 Directed Reading / Independent Study.
2.2.4 External credit-bearing courses approved under credit equivalency or transfer frameworks.

3. Definitions

3.1 Prerequisite Course

A course that must be successfully completed (minimum passing grade) before a student is permitted to register for a higher-level or dependent course.

3.2 Dependent Course

A course that builds on knowledge, skills, or competencies acquired in a prerequisite course.

3.3 Prerequisite Clearance

Formal academic confirmation that a student has met the prerequisite requirement through:

3.3.1 Passing the course; or
3.3.2 Approved equivalent credit transfer.

3.4 Prerequisite Override

A formally approved academic exception permitting concurrent registration in a dependent course despite incomplete prerequisite clearance, subject to conditions specified in this Policy.

4. Prerequisite Mapping Framework

4.1 Mandatory Prerequisite Mapping

4.1.1 Every course offered at UPES shall have one of the following clearly declared:

4.1.1.1 No prerequisite; or
4.1.1.2 Specified prerequisite course(s).

4.1.2 Prerequisites must be:

4.1.2.1 Approved by the Board of Studies (BoS); and
4.1.2.2 Reflected in:

- Programme curriculum documents
- Course catalogue
- ERP (Orange) course master.

4.2 Types of Prerequisites

Prerequisites may be defined as:

4.2.1 Sequential prerequisites
(e.g., Data Structures → Algorithms)

4.2.2 Competency-based prerequisites
(e.g., Research Methodology before Dissertation)

4.2.3 Foundation prerequisites
(e.g., Mathematics I before Engineering Core courses)

5. Enforcement Mechanism

5.1 ERP-Based Enforcement (Primary Control)

5.1.1 Prerequisite enforcement shall be system-driven through Orange (ERP).

5.1.2 Students shall not be allowed to register for a dependent course unless:

5.1.2.1 The prerequisite course is successfully cleared; or
5.1.2.2 A valid equivalent credit is recorded in ERP.

5.1.3 Manual overrides are not permitted, except as explicitly provided under this Policy.

5.1.4 ERP controls shall function as the primary enforcement mechanism; however, academic responsibility for prerequisite validation shall remain with the School.

5.2 Academic Consequences of Non-Clearance

5.2.1 If a student has not cleared a prerequisite course:

5.2.1.1 Registration for the dependent course shall be blocked.
5.2.1.2 The student must pursue an approved Recovery Pathway, such as:

- Supplementary Examination (if eligible)
- Summer Semester
- Directed Reading / Independent Study
- Course Repeat.

5.2.2 Prerequisite requirements shall not be waived to enable progression.

6. Prerequisite Override – Exceptional Provision

6.1 Principle

6.1.1 Prerequisite override is not a right and shall be permitted only in rare, academically justified circumstances, as determined through documented academic justification aligned with course outcome mapping.

6.2 Permissible Grounds for Override

6.2.1 Overrides may be considered only where the prerequisite is not central to the learning outcomes of the dependent course.

6.3 Approval Authority

6.3.1 Overrides require:

6.3.1.1 Recommendation by the Programme Lead / Cluster Head; and
6.3.1.2 Approval by the Dean of the School.

6.3.2 All overrides must be:

- Time-bound
- Recorded in ERP
- Reported to APO.

7. Explicit Prohibitions

7.1 Prerequisite override shall **not** be permitted in the following cases:

7.1.1 Attendance-related failure in the prerequisite.
7.1.2 Repeated failure of the prerequisite course.
7.1.3 Professional or statutory programmes where prerequisites are mandated.
7.1.4 To accommodate timetable clashes, convenience, or graduation pressure.

8. Student Responsibility & Disclosure

8.1 Prerequisite requirements shall be:

8.1.1 Published in the course catalogue; and
8.1.2 Visible in ERP at the time of registration.

8.2 Students are responsible for:

8.2.1 Planning their academic pathway accordingly; and
8.2.2 Clearing prerequisites within prescribed timelines.

8.3 Ignorance of prerequisite requirements shall not constitute grounds for academic exception.

9. Monitoring, Reporting & Audit

9.1 Each School shall submit a semester-wise report on:

9.1.1 Blocked registrations due to prerequisites; and
9.1.2 Overrides granted (if any).

9.2 APO shall submit to Academic Council:

9.2.1 Conduct periodic audits; and
9.2.2 Flag non-compliant patterns.

10. Authority to Amend

10.1 The Academic Council reserves the right to:

10.1.1 Amend;
10.1.2 Clarify; and
10.1.3 Interpret

this Policy in the interest of academic governance and curriculum integrity.

QUESTION PAPER & RESULT MODERATION POLICY

(Policy Code: AG-21)

This Policy shall come into force ***with immediate effect.***

1. Purpose

1.1 The UPES Moderation Policy establishes a robust, fair, and auditable framework for moderation of question papers and results, ensuring:

1.1.1 Consistency and parity in assessment standards across courses, sections, and Schools.
1.1.2 Alignment of assessments with approved Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) and rubrics.
1.1.3 Elimination of bias, subjectivity, and unintended academic distortion.
1.1.4 Compliance with UGC regulations, accreditation standards, and institutional quality assurance expectations.
1.1.5 Transparency, accountability, and traceability in all moderation decisions.

2. Scope & Applicability

2.1 Programmes Covered

2.1.1 This Policy applies to all Undergraduate, Postgraduate, and Doctoral programmes of UPES.
2.1.2 For Doctoral programmes, moderation shall apply only to coursework assessments. Thesis evaluation shall be governed by separate PhD regulations.

2.2 Assessment Components Covered

2.2.1 End-Term examinations.
2.2.2 Supplementary examinations.
2.2.3 Centrally conducted written examinations (offline or online).
2.2.4 Continuous Assessment (CA), mid-term examinations, projects, juries, dissertations, and viva-voce, as applicable.

2.3 Tiered Applicability

2.3.1 Mandatory Institutional Moderation shall apply to:

- End-Term examinations.
- Supplementary examinations.
- Final result consolidation at course and programme level.

2.3.2 School-Level Moderation shall apply to:

- Mid-term examinations.
- Continuous Assessment components.
- Project-based and studio assessments.

2.3.3 School-level moderation shall be conducted through rubric verification, peer review, and anomaly checks, without mandatory statistical normalization unless explicitly directed by the Examination Committee.

3. Definitions

3.1 **Mark Freezing**: Locking of evaluated marks on ERP prior to moderation.

3.2 **CA Verification**: School-level validation of Continuous Assessment marks.

3.3 **Course Summary Upload**: ERP-generated statistical snapshot including enrolment count (N), mean, standard deviation, histogram, and grade spread.

3.4 **Normalization**: Statistical adjustment applied to ensure parity across sections or cohorts.

3.5 **Small Cohort**: Course with enrolment less than twenty-one (21) students.

4. Guiding Principles

4.1 Moderation shall be guided by the following principles:

4.1.1 **Fairness & Consistency** – Uniform academic standards across courses and Schools.
4.1.2 **Transparency** – All moderation actions shall be recorded with documented justification.
4.1.3 **Evidence-Based Decision Making** – Moderation decisions shall be driven by data and documented academic rationale.
4.1.4 **Timeliness** – Moderation shall be completed prior to result publication.
4.1.5 **Accountability** – Clear ownership and academic sign-offs shall be maintained at each stage.

5. Question Paper Moderation

5.1 Purpose

5.1.1 To ensure question papers are syllabus-complete, CLO-aligned, balanced in difficulty, and free from ambiguity or bias.

5.2 Platform

5.2.1 All Question Paper moderation shall be conducted digitally through the University ERP.

5.3 Mandatory Requirements

5.3.1 CLO mapping for each question.
5.3.2 Bloom's Taxonomy tagging.
5.3.3 Internal moderation with recorded academic comments.
5.3.4 Multi-level academic approval workflow.
5.3.5 ERP lock and archival of approved papers.

5.3.6 Approved question papers shall form the baseline reference for subsequent result moderation.

6. Result Moderation

6.1 Result moderation ensures parity, fairness, and consistency in grading across:

6.1.1 Sections of the same course.
6.1.2 Courses within a programme.
6.1.3 Schools across the University.

6.2 Result moderation may include anomaly review, statistical diagnostics, rubric alignment checks, and limited normalization where academically justified.

7. Levels of Moderation

7.1 Moderation shall operate at two defined levels:

7.1.1 Level 1 – Course Level

- Responsibility: Course Evaluator / Course Coordinator.
- Scope: Initial mark validation, rubric checks, and anomaly review.

7.1.2 Level 2 – Institutional Level

- Responsibility: Examination Committee (chaired by the Controller of Examinations or nominee).
- Scope: Institutional moderation review, normalization approval, and policy compliance oversight.
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8. Bell Curve Normalization

8.1 Rationale

8.1.1 Normalization is a diagnostic and corrective academic tool and shall not be interpreted as a mechanical forcing of marks into a statistical curve.

8.1.2 Normalization shall not compensate for fundamentally flawed assessment design or evaluation errors.

8.2 Applicability

8.2.1 Normalization may apply to:

- Courses with enrolment of twenty-one (21) students or more.
- Multi-section or high-variance courses.
- Centrally assessed, theory-heavy courses.
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8.3 Explicit Exclusions

8.3.1 Normalization shall not apply to:

- Dissertations and theses.
- Viva-voce and oral examinations.
- Studio, design, or jury-based assessments.
- School for Life (SFL) courses.
- Small cohorts with enrolment less than twenty-one (21) students.

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8.3.2 School-level moderation shall not include statistical normalization unless formally approved by the Examination Committee.

9. Normalization Parameters (Indicative)

9.1 The following parameters serve as indicative academic benchmarks:

9.1.1 Target Mean: 65 ± 5 or aligned with the three-year School average.
9.1.2 Target Standard Deviation: 10–12.
9.1.3 Individual Adjustment Cap: ±8 marks or ±10%.
9.1.4 Pass/Fail Protection: No status change due solely to normalization.
9.1.5 Section Parity: Mean difference should normally remain within 3–5 marks.

9.2 The Examination Committee may deviate from these benchmarks with documented academic justification.

10. Data, Analytics & ERP Dependency

10.1 Moderation shall rely primarily on ERP-generated analytics.

10.2 Where ERP dashboards are unavailable, standardized manual reports approved by the Controller of Examinations may be used on a transitional basis.

11. Examination Committee

11.1 The Examination Committee shall:

11.1.1 Validate moderation and normalization outputs.
11.1.2 Approve deviations and exceptional academic decisions.
11.1.3 Ensure audit compliance and institutional consistency.

11.2 The Examination Committee shall focus on policy judgments and exceptions rather than raw data processing.

12. Conflict of Interest & Recusal

12.1 Any faculty member or academic official directly involved in setting, moderating, or evaluating a question paper or course shall recuse themselves from:

12.1.1 Examination Committee deliberations; and
12.1.2 Moderation or normalization decisions related to that specific course.

12.2 All recusals shall be formally recorded to ensure transparency, impartiality, and audit defensibility.

13. Documentation & Record Retention

13.1 Mandatory records include:

13.1.1 Question Paper Moderation Reports.
13.1.2 Course-wise Moderation Summary Sheets.
13.1.3 Exception and Deviation Logs.
13.1.4 Examination Committee Reports.

13.2 All records shall be retained for a minimum of three (3) years unless extended by regulatory requirement.

14. Communication & Transparency

14.1 Specific statistical parameters or internal normalization algorithms shall not be disclosed to students.

14.2 A general statement may be included in academic handbooks indicating that results may undergo moderation as part of institutional quality assurance.

14.3 Moderation is an institutional academic process and shall not be construed as a mechanism for individual re-evaluation, re-checking, or grievance redressal.

15. Reporting & Continuous Improvement

15.1 The Controller of Examinations shall submit a Semester Moderation Report to the Academic Council.

15.2 Persistent anomalies identified through moderation may trigger:

15.2.1 Rubric revision.
15.2.2 Assessment redesign.
15.2.3 Targeted faculty development interventions.

16. University Authority & Discretion

16.1 The University reserves the right to revise moderation methodologies, analytical parameters, thresholds, and operational mechanisms to ensure regulatory compliance, academic rigor, and institutional alignment.

16.2 All changes shall be formally notified and shall be binding from the notified date.

COMPOSITE TEACHING QUALITY FEEDBACK FRAMEWORK

(Policy Code: AG -22)

This Policy shall come into force ***with immediate effect.***

1. Purpose

1.1 The Composite Teaching Quality Framework establishes a structured, transparent, outcome-oriented, and development-focused institutional mechanism for evaluating and enhancing teaching effectiveness at UPES.

1.2 The Framework aims to:

1.2.1 Enhance academic quality and student learning experience.
1.2.2 Promote reflective, student-centric, and outcome-based teaching practices.
1.2.3 Enable continuous professional development of faculty.
1.2.4 Institutionalize a culture of transparency, accountability, and continuous quality improvement.
1.2.5 Integrate teaching effectiveness with institutional performance metrics.

2. Scope & Applicability

2.1 This Framework applies to:

2.1.1 All Schools and Academic Departments of UPES.
2.1.2 All full-time and adjunct faculty teaching regular academic programmes.
2.1.3 All students enrolled in regular academic programmes.
2.1.4 Academic Planning & Operations (APO).
2.1.5 Internal Quality Assurance Cell (IQAC).
2.1.6 ERP / IT Teams.
2.1.7 Examination Department (for hall ticket linkage purposes).
2.1.8 Human Resources Department.
2.1.9 Centre of Teaching and Learning (CTL).

2.2 This Framework shall operate in conjunction with the approved Teaching Quality SOP.

3. Definitions

3.1 Teaching Quality (TQ)

3.1.1 Teaching Quality refers to the overall effectiveness of a faculty member in:

3.1.1.1 Delivering course content.
3.1.1.2 Facilitating student learning.
3.1.1.3 Ensuring assessment transparency.
3.1.1.4 Maintaining academic rigor.
3.1.1.5 Supporting diverse learners.
3.1.1.6 Creating an inclusive and engaging classroom environment.

3.2 Teaching Quality Feedback Score (TQF)

3.2.1 The weighted and normalised student feedback score.

3.3 Average Student Attendance (ASA)

3.3.1 ASA is defined as the average attendance percentage of students in courses, converted into a normalised score using the institution's approved attendance scale.

3.4 Class Taken Index (CTI)

3.4.1 Class Taken Index represents the normalised score reflecting the percentage of scheduled classes actually conducted by a faculty member.

3.5 Programme Median Salary Index (PMSI)

3.5.1 PMSI is defined as the ratio of the median salary of a School to its target median salary, used as a normalised programme-level indicator.

3.6 Composite Teaching Quality Score (CTQS)

3.6.1 A composite, formula-driven institutional score measuring teaching effectiveness by integrating:

- Student Feedback.
- Student Engagement Indicators.
- Instructional Compliance.
- Programme-level academic outcomes.

4. Guiding Principles

4.1 The Framework shall be governed by the following principles:

4.1.1 **Confidentiality & Anonymity** – No disclosure of student identity.
4.1.2 **Objectivity & Multi-Source Evaluation** – Multiple academic indicators used.
4.1.3 **Development Orientation** – Improvement-focused, not punitive.
4.1.4 **Transparency** – Clear communication of process and outcomes.
4.1.5 **Equity & Normalisation** – Fair comparison across Schools and batch sizes.
4.1.6 **Continuous Quality Improvement (CQI)** – Integrated with institutional quality cycles.

5. Teaching Quality Feedback Cycles

Teaching Quality feedback shall be conducted twice per semester.

5.1 Mid-Semester Feedback (Developmental Cycle)

5.1.1 Mid-Semester Feedback functions as an early diagnostic and mentoring mechanism focused exclusively on classroom teaching practices.

5.1.2 It is intended to:

5.1.2.1 Provide early insights into teaching effectiveness.
5.1.2.2 Enable timely course correction.
5.1.2.3 Improve teaching quality within the same semester.

5.1.3 Mid-Semester Feedback is strictly developmental and shall not be used for PMS scoring or disciplinary decisions

5.1.4 Scope includes:

- Clarity of course plan and CO alignment.
- Regularity and preparedness.
- Concept explanation and subject delivery.
- Session structure and pedagogy.
- Student engagement.
- Transparency in assessment expectations.
- Use of learning resources.

5.2 End-Semester Feedback (Evaluative Cycle)

5.2.1 End-Semester Feedback shall be conducted prior to the End-Semester Examination.

5.2.2 Completion of this feedback shall be mandatory and linked to hall ticket download.

5.2.3 End-Semester Feedback may include:

- Overall teaching effectiveness.
- Assessment fairness.
- Academic support.
- Learning satisfaction.
- Course completion experience.
-

6. Teaching Quality Feedback Process

6.1 The institutional process shall include:

6.1.1 Approval of the Teaching Quality questionnaire by Academic Council.
6.1.2 ERP configuration and notification.
6.1.3 Two structured feedback cycles.
6.1.4 Data validation and normalisation.
6.1.5 Score computation.
6.1.6 Faculty report dissemination.
6.1.7 School-level analysis.
6.1.8 Action Taken Reports (ATR).
6.1.9 Documentation for accreditation and audit.

6.2 Detailed timelines and workflows shall be governed by the Teaching Quality SOP.

7. Composite Teaching Quality Measurement Framework

Teaching Quality shall be measured using a Composite Teaching Quality Score (CTQS), calculated across courses taught.

7.1 Components & Weightage

7.1.1 CTQS shall be calculated using the following components:

Component	Description	Weightage
Teaching Quality Feedback (TQF)	Weighted student feedback	25%
Average Student Attendance (ASA)	Attendance engagement indicator	25%
Class Taken Index (CTI)	Instructional compliance	25%
Programme Median Salary Index (PMSI)	Programme-level outcome indicator	25%

CTQS = 0.25(TQF) + 0.25(ASA) + 0.25(CTI) + 0.25(PMSI)

7.1.1 Teaching Quality Feedback (TQF)

7.1.1.1 TQF represents the weighted and workload-adjusted student feedback score across all courses taught.

7.1.1.2 Workload Compensation Factor:

- Adjusts for variation in class size.
- Derived from institutional benchmark class size.
- Ensures fairness without artificial score inflation.
- Governed through a technical annexure approved by Academic Council.

7.1.1.3 TQ Ratio Formula:

Average Class Size × Number of Courses

Standard Benchmark Class Size (e.g., 45)

7.1.1.4 Rating Scale:

Rating	Score Range	Interpretation
5	4.50 & above	Excellent
4	4.00 – 4.49	Very Good
3	3.50 – 3.99	Good / Satisfactory
2	3.00 – 3.49	Needs Improvement
1	Below 3.00	Critical Concern

7.1.2 Average Student Attendance (ASA)

Attendance %	Normalised Score
≥ 90%	5
85–89%	4

80–84%	3
75–79%	2
< 75%	1

Average across all courses taught.

7.1.3 Class Taken Index (CTI)

Classes Conducted %	Normalised Score
≥ 98%	5
95–97%	4
92–94%	3
90–91%	2
< 90%	1

7.1.4 Programme Median Salary Index (PMSI)

Median Salary of School

Target Salary of School

7.1.4.1 Institutional Target Salary shall be approved by the University.

7.1.4.2 This ensures:

- Comparability across Schools.
- Alignment with strategic placement goals and rankings/accreditation.
- Standardised scaling.

8. Visibility & Transparency

8.1 Faculty shall have ERP access to:

8.1.1 Course-wise TQF.
8.1.2 CTQS.
8.1.3 School-level benchmarks.
8.1.4 Trend analytics.

8.2 Student identities shall remain anonymised.

9. Action Taken Report (ATR)

9.1 Faculty shall submit ATR within ten (10) working days including:

9.1.1 Identified gaps.
9.1.2 Corrective steps.
9.1.3 Support required.

9.2 ATR review shall be documented at School level.

10. Integration with CTL

10.1 The Centre of Teaching and Learning (CTL) shall:

- 10.1.1 Design targeted Faculty Development Programmes (FDPs).
- 10.1.2 Link training interventions to Teaching Quality dimensions.
- 10.1.3 Maintain impact records.
- 10.1.4 Provide mentoring pathways.

11. Integration with PMS

11.1 Teaching Quality shall form part of PMS considering:

- 11.1.1 CTQS trends.
- 11.1.2 Year-on-year improvement.
- 11.1.3 ATR responsiveness.
- 11.1.4 FDP participation.

11.2 CTQS shall not be used in isolation for disciplinary action.

12. Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

12.1 PIP shall be triggered when:

- 12.1.1 TQF is below 3.0 in two consecutive evaluative cycles; or
- 12.1.2 CTQS shows sustained decline despite mentoring.

12.2 PIP shall include:

- 12.2.1 Diagnostic review.
- 12.2.2 Three-to-six-month improvement targets.
- 12.2.3 Mandatory FDP participation.
- 12.2.4 Review and closure documentation.

13. Closing the Feedback Loop

13.1 UPES shall ensure:

- 13.1.1 “You Said – We Did” communication.
- 13.1.2 School-level improvement sharing.
- 13.1.3 Encouragement of student participation

14. Documentation & Audit

14.1 Records shall be:

14.1.1 Maintained semester-wise.
14.1.2 Stored with version control.
14.1.3 Used for NAAC, NBA, QS, THE, and internal audits